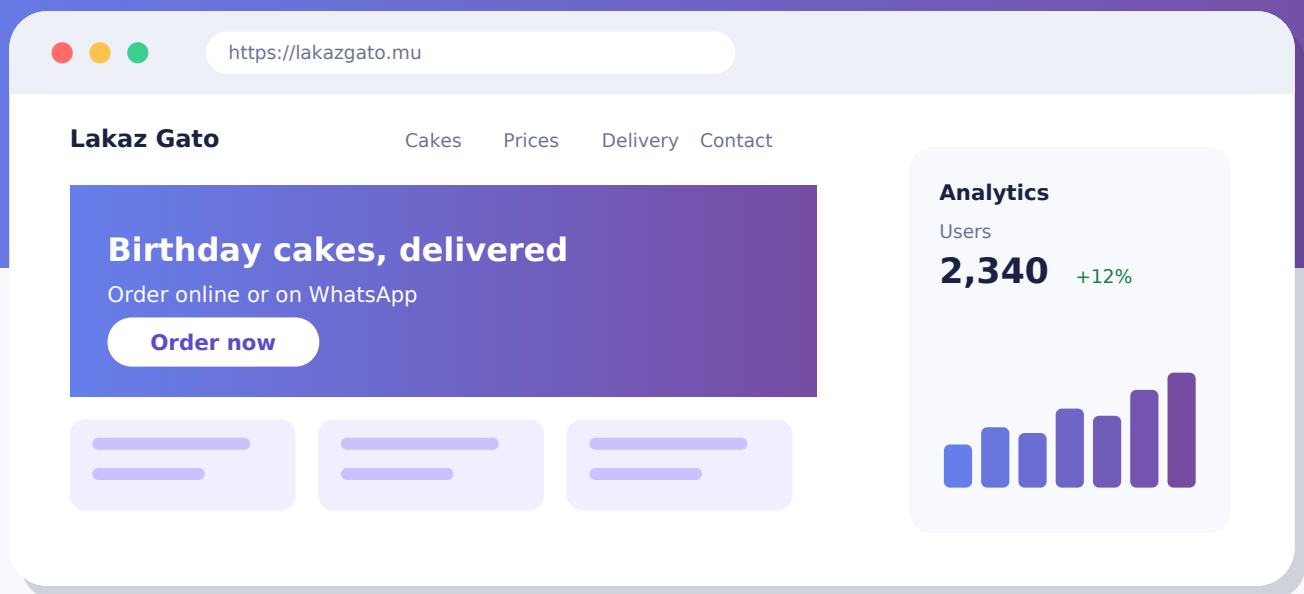


Websites & Analytics

The complete guide to building, measuring and improving a website, with Mauritian examples

Avinesh Bundhoo & Fareez Fawdar · Oreegami Mauritius · October 2026



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PART A

Your website

Why it matters, how it works,
and how to plan it

SECTION 1

Why your website matters

Social media pages, Google Maps listings and marketplaces are useful, but they belong to someone else. Your website is the one place online that you fully own and control. Think of it as your **shop window, open 24 hours a day, 7 days a week**.

Your website: the shop window that never closes

Four jobs every business website does

FIRST IMPRESSION
Judged in seconds
About 75% of people judge a brand's credibility from its website design.
Look professional, load fast

ALWAYS OPEN
24/7, 365 days
It answers, sells and takes bookings while you sleep or are on holiday.
Prices, hours, FAQ online

SILENT SALESPERSON
Guides to action
It answers questions, builds trust and leads people to book, buy or contact you.
One clear call to action

THE HUB
Owned and measurable
Ads, social, email and Google send people here, and analytics shows what works.
Your data, your rules

Your website in the digital ecosystem

In Week 1 we saw that almost every channel sends people somewhere: an Instagram ad, a Google result, an email newsletter, a WhatsApp message with a link. In most cases that "somewhere" should be your website, because it is where you can:

- **Control the message:** your words, your photos, your prices, no algorithm deciding who sees what.
- **Convert:** take orders, bookings and enquiries directly, without paying a commission to a platform.
- **Measure:** with Google Analytics 4 you see where visitors come from and what they do (Part C of this guide).
- **Build first-party data:** emails, phone numbers and purchase history that belong to you.
- **Be found on Google:** a website with useful pages can bring free visitors for years (Week 3).

Website or "just a Facebook page"?

	Facebook / Instagram page only	Your own website
Ownership	The platform owns the page and the rules	You own the domain and the content
Reach	Depends on the algorithm; organic reach is low	Visitors from Google, ads, email, social
Information	Short posts that disappear in the feed	Organised pages: services, prices, FAQ
Selling	Orders by message, hard to scale	Online orders, bookings, payments
Measurement	Platform statistics only	Full analytics across all channels
Trust	Fine for small or informal businesses	Looks established and professional

In Mauritius: many small businesses start on Facebook and WhatsApp only, and that is a good start. The website does not replace them: it becomes the base that every channel points to. Even a simple 5-page site with a WhatsApp button, prices and a map makes a business look more credible and easier to find on Google.

Three facts to remember

Fact	What it means
About 75% of people judge a company's credibility from its website design	An outdated or broken site costs trust, even if your product is excellent
Many mobile visitors leave if a page takes more than 3 seconds to load (Google research found 53%)	Speed is not a technical detail: it is lost customers
Most visits now come from smartphones	Design for the phone first, then the computer

SECTION 2

Types of websites

Not every business needs the same kind of website. Start from your business goal (Week 1): do you want enquiries, bookings, online sales or readers?

Six types of websites

Pick the one that matches your business goal

BUSINESS SITE Showcase / brochure Who you are, what you offer, how to contact you. Accountant, plumber, clinic	LANDING PAGE One page, one goal Built for a campaign: one offer, one form or button. Ad for a free trial class	E-COMMERCE Online shop Product catalogue, cart, checkout, delivery. Clothing, cakes, electronics
BOOKING SITE Reservations Availability calendar and direct booking. Guesthouse, salon, restaurant	CONTENT / BLOG Media and guides Articles and videos that attract search traffic. Travel guide, news, recipes	PORTFOLIO Show your work Galleries and case studies for creative work. Photographer, architect, designer

Business	Main goal	Best type of site	Must-have features
Plumber in Vacoas	Calls and WhatsApp enquiries	Business site (5-8 pages)	Click-to-call, WhatsApp button, service areas, photos of jobs
Guesthouse in Trou aux Biches	Direct bookings	Booking site	Availability calendar, room pages, prices, reviews, EN/FR
Cake shop in Rose Hill	Orders for delivery	Small e-commerce or order form	Product gallery, prices, delivery zones, order form or cart
Fashion brand	Online sales	E-commerce	Catalogue, sizes, cart, payment, delivery and returns policy
Training company	Leads for courses	Business site + landing pages	Course pages, dates, enquiry forms, testimonials

Business	Main goal	Best type of site	Must-have features
Photographer	Showcase work, get bookings	Portfolio	Galleries, packages, contact form, Instagram feed

Landing pages: one page, one goal

A **landing page** is a page built for one campaign and one action, for example "Book your free trial class" from a Facebook ad. It has no menu to distract people, one headline that matches the ad, the key benefits, proof (reviews, photos) and one form or button. Landing pages usually convert better than sending ad traffic to the home page.

Tip: you don't need a different website for each campaign. Most platforms let you create landing pages inside your main site (for example lakazgato.mu/fete-des-meres for a Mother's Day offer).

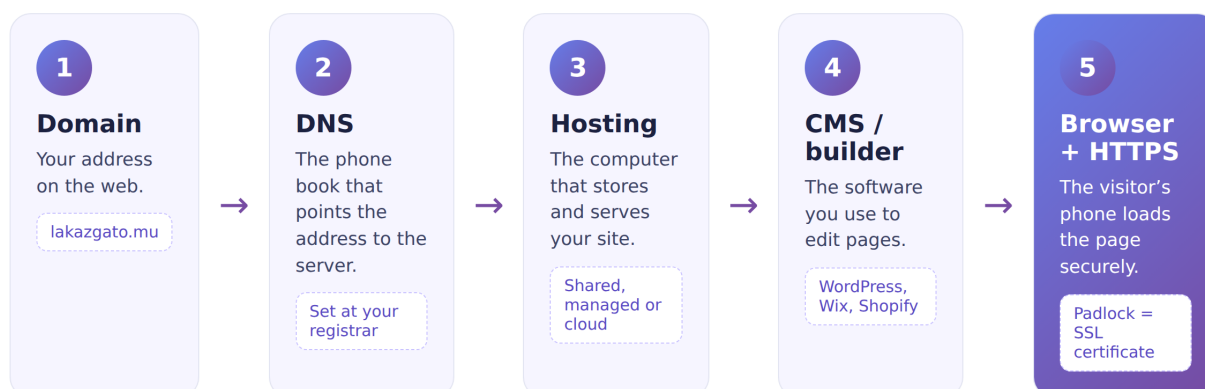
SECTION 3

How a website works

You don't need to be technical to manage a website, but you should understand the building blocks, so you can talk to developers and avoid expensive mistakes.

How a website reaches a visitor

The five building blocks behind every site



Building block	What it is	What you need to know
Domain name	Your address, e.g. lakazgato.mu or lakazgato.com	Buy it in the business's name , not the developer's. Renew it every year (set auto-renew).
DNS	Settings that connect your domain to your website and email	You will edit DNS to connect a builder, verify Google tools or set up email.
Hosting	The server that stores your site and sends it to visitors	Fast, reliable hosting matters for speed. Builders like Wix and Shopify include hosting.
SSL certificate (HTTPS)	Encrypts the connection; shows the padlock	Essential for trust and Google. Most hosts provide it free.
CMS / website builder	The software you use to edit pages	WordPress, Wix, Shopify, Squarespace... see Section 4.
Professional email	name@yourdomain.mu	Looks more serious than a free address; Google Workspace or Microsoft 365.

Own your accounts. The domain, hosting, website builder, Google Analytics, Google Tag Manager and Google Business Profile should all be registered with the business's email, with the developer or agency added as a user. Many Mauritian businesses lose their website or data when a freelancer disappears with the logins.

.mu or .com?

A **.mu** domain tells visitors and Google that you are a Mauritian business, which helps for local searches. A **.com** is familiar internationally (useful for tourism or export). Many businesses register both and redirect one to the other. Keep the name short, easy to spell and easy to say on the phone.

SECTION 4

Choosing a platform

The platform (CMS or website builder) is the tool you will use every week. Choose the one that fits your goal, budget and skills, not the one your developer prefers.

Platform	Best for	Strengths	Watch out for
WordPress (with a theme)	Business sites, blogs, bigger projects	Most popular CMS in the world (over 40% of websites); thousands of plugins; full control; strong SEO	Needs updates, security and good hosting; too many plugins slow it down
WooCommerce (on WordPress)	Online shops on WordPress	Flexible, many payment and delivery plugins	More maintenance than hosted shops
Shopify	E-commerce	Easy to run a shop; hosting, security and checkout included	Monthly fees and app costs; check which payment providers work in Mauritius
Wix	Small business sites	Drag-and-drop, quick to launch, hosting included	Less flexible for complex sites; harder to move away
Squarespace	Portfolios, design-led brands	Beautiful templates	Fewer integrations and local payment options
Webflow	Designers, custom marketing sites	Design freedom, fast, clean code	Learning curve
Custom-coded	Special needs, large companies	Anything is possible	Expensive to build and change; depends on developers

Questions to ask before you choose

1. What is the main goal: enquiries, bookings or online sales?
2. Who will update the site every week, and how technical are they?
3. Do you need online payments? Which payment gateway (your bank's card gateway, PayPal, others) works with the platform in Mauritius?
4. Do you need English and French versions?
5. What is the total yearly cost: domain, hosting or subscription, theme, plugins/apps, maintenance?
6. Can you export your content if you move later?
7. Does it make it easy to add tracking: Google Analytics 4, Google Tag Manager and the Meta Pixel (Facebook/Instagram ads tracking), all explained in Part C?

In Mauritius: online payments are the most common blocker. Before choosing an e-commerce platform, check with your bank which card payment gateways are available for your type of business, and whether the platform supports them. Many local shops also accept bank transfer, payment on delivery or mobile payment apps, so the website can start with an order form and add card payments later.

SECTION 5

Planning your website

Most website projects that go wrong skipped planning. One day of planning saves weeks of changes. The plan has five parts.

1 • Goal and KPIs

Write one sentence: "The website's main job is to" Then choose how you will measure it (Week 1 SMART objectives). Example: "Get 40 cake orders per month through the website within 3 months, measured by order-form submissions in GA4."

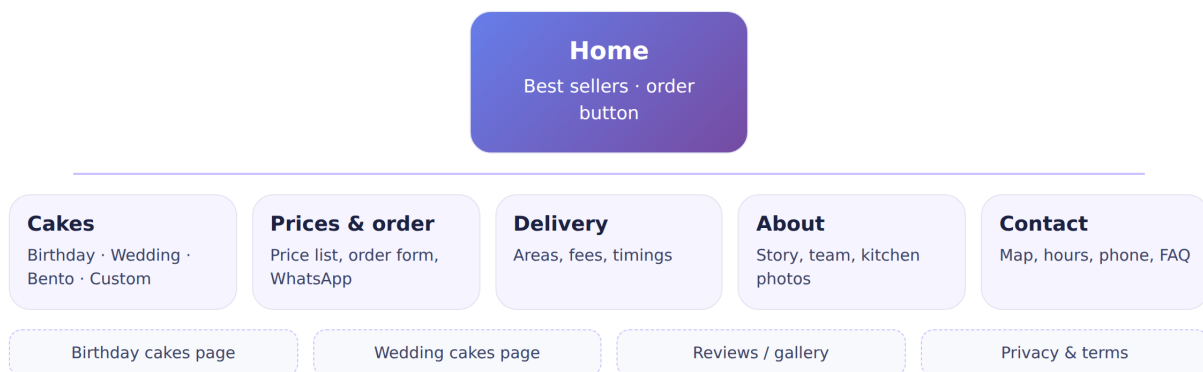
2 • Audience

Who visits, on which device, in which language, and what do they want to know before they buy? For a guesthouse: tourists from France and Réunion on mobile, who want prices, photos, location and how to get there from the airport.

3 • Site structure (sitemap)

Plan your site structure (sitemap)

Example: Lakaz Gato, a cake shop in Rose Hill (fictional)



Keep it simple: every important page should be reachable in **3 clicks or fewer**. Group content the way customers think ("Birthday cakes"), not the way the business is organised internally.

4 • Content plan

For each page, decide...	Example: "Birthday cakes" page
Main goal of the page	Get a cake order
Main keyword (Week 3)	birthday cake rose hill / gâteau anniversaire
Key message	Custom birthday cakes, delivered in Plaines Wilhems
Content needed	Photos of 12 cakes, prices by size, flavours, order deadline, delivery fees
Call to action	"Order on WhatsApp" + order form
Proof	3 customer reviews with photos

5 • Wireframe

A wireframe is a simple sketch of each page's layout (boxes, not design). Draw it on paper or in Canva before anyone builds anything. It forces decisions: what goes at the top, where the button is, what the visitor sees first on a phone.

Tip: collect real content before the design: photos, prices, opening hours, texts, reviews. Waiting for content is the most common reason website projects are late.

SECTION 6

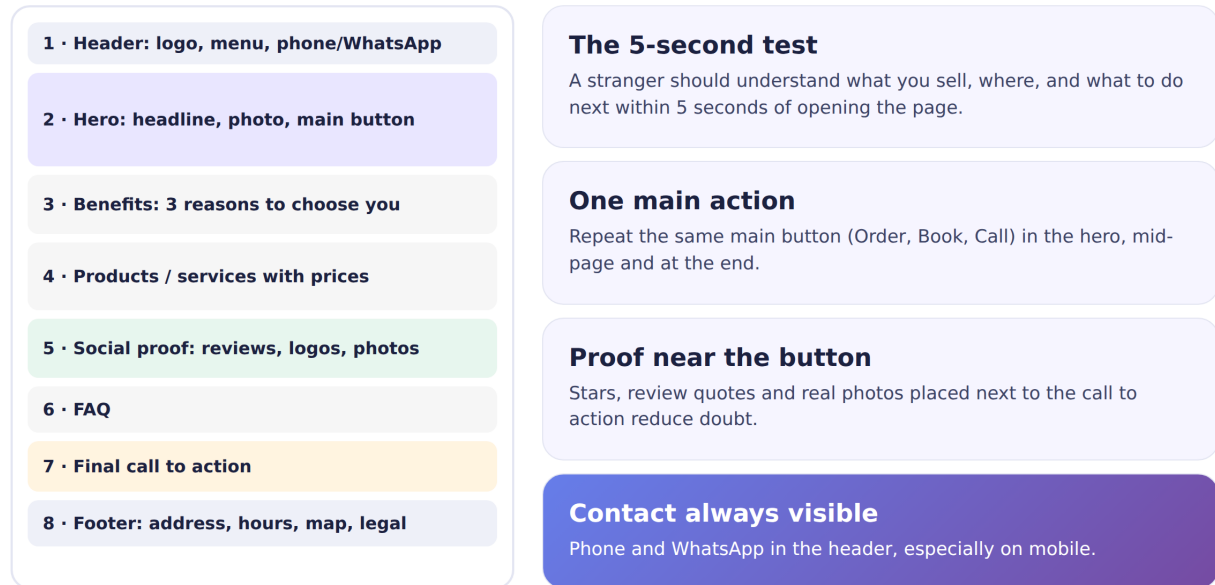
Essential pages and content

Most business websites need the same core pages. Each one has a specific job.

Page	Its job	What it must include
Home	Explain who you are and send people to the right page	Clear headline, main button, best products/services, proof, contact
Products / services	Help people choose	One page per main service or category, photos, prices or ranges, FAQ
Prices	Remove the #1 question	Price list or "from Rs ...", what's included, payment options
About	Build trust	Story, team photos, experience, values, BRN (Business Registration Number)
Reviews / gallery	Social proof	Google reviews, testimonials, before/after, real photos
Contact	Make it easy to reach you	Phone, WhatsApp, email, address, map, opening hours, form
FAQ	Answer questions before they are asked	Delivery, payment, cancellation, parking, languages
Blog / guides	Attract search traffic (Week 3-4)	Useful articles answering customer questions
Legal pages	Protect the business and visitors	Privacy policy, terms, cookie information, returns policy for shops
Thank-you page	Confirm the action and track it	Next steps, contact, a link back; used to measure conversions

Anatomy of a homepage that converts

Top to bottom, what each block must do



Writing for the web

- **Lead with the benefit**, not the company: "Birthday cakes delivered to your door" beats "Welcome to our website".
- **Short paragraphs** (2-3 lines on mobile), bullet points and clear subheadings: people scan, they don't read.
- **Use the customer's words**, in English and/or French, including the words they search on Google.
- **Be specific**: prices, delivery areas, opening hours, how long things take.
- **One page, one goal**: every page should end with a clear next step.
- **Real photos** of your products, team and premises build more trust than stock images.

SECTION 7

Page templates: what to write

A blank page is the hardest part of a website project. Use these templates as a starting point and adapt them to your business, in English and/or French. The examples are for the fictional cake shop Lakaz Gato.

Home page

Block	Template	Example
Headline	[What you offer] + [for whom / where]	Custom birthday cakes, delivered across Plaines Wilhems
Sub-headline	[Main benefit] + [proof or differentiator]	Baked fresh to order in Rose Hill since 2015. 4.9★ from 300+ Google reviews.
Main button	[Action verb] + [result]	Order my cake · Chat on WhatsApp
3 benefits	Short title + one sentence each	Fresh every day · Your design, your flavours · Delivery at the time you choose
Products	3-6 best sellers with photo, name, "from" price, button	Chocolate fudge, from Rs 1,200 · See all cakes
Social proof	2-3 reviews with first name and town, or a Google rating widget	"The cake was the star of the party!" - Priya, Quatre Bornes
FAQ	4-6 questions customers really ask	How far in advance should I order?
Final call to action	Repeat the main button with a reason to act now	Order by Thursday for weekend delivery

Service or product page

1. **Headline with the keyword:** "Wedding cakes in Mauritius".
2. **Who it is for and the result they get** (2-3 sentences).
3. **What's included:** sizes, flavours, options, timing, delivery.
4. **Prices** or price ranges, and what affects the price.
5. **Photos** of real work (8-12), with descriptive alt text.
6. **How it works** in 3-4 steps (consultation → tasting → design → delivery).
7. **Reviews** specific to this service.
8. **FAQ** for this service.
9. **Call to action:** form, WhatsApp or booking button.

About page

Tell a short, true story: who started the business and why, what makes you different, the team (with photos and first names), your values, years of experience, certifications or awards, your BRN and address. People buy from people: a real face is one of the strongest trust signals on a small business website.

Contact page

Must have	Nice to have
Phone (click-to-call), WhatsApp button, email	Short form for people who prefer to write
Address and an embedded Google Map	Directions, parking and landmarks ("opposite the bus station")
Opening hours, including public holidays	Expected reply time ("we answer within 2 hours")
Legal business name and BRN	Links to social profiles and the Google Business Profile

Tip: AI writing tools can help you produce a first draft of these pages quickly (Section 16). Always rewrite with your real details, prices and tone of voice, and check every fact.

SECTION 8

Design basics for non-designers

You don't need to be a designer to have a good-looking website. Most of good web design is consistency, space and real photos.

Element	Rule of thumb	Common mistake
Brand colours	1 main colour, 1 accent colour for buttons, neutrals (white, greys, dark text)	Rainbow pages where every section has a different colour
Fonts	1 font for headings, 1 for text (or one family in two weights); body text 16 px+	4-5 different fonts; light grey text that is hard to read
Logo	A clean version for light and dark backgrounds; a small square icon (favicon)	A blurry logo copied from a Facebook profile picture
Photos	Your own, well lit, consistent style; compressed for the web	Stock photos of people who obviously aren't your team
Icons and illustrations	One consistent style (all outline or all filled)	Mixing clip-art styles
Layout and spacing	Generous white space; align everything to a grid; same spacing between sections	Every corner filled with text, banners and pop-ups
Buttons	Same shape and accent colour everywhere; action words	Links that look like plain text, or text that looks like a button
Consistency	Same look on the website, social media, ads and documents	A website that looks like a different company from the Instagram page

Taking good photos with a phone

- Use natural daylight near a window; avoid the flash.
- Clean, simple background; show the product clearly, then close-ups of details.
- Take horizontal photos for website banners and vertical ones for social media and mobile.
- Show people using the product or service (with their permission).
- Keep a consistent style (same light, angle and background) across all product photos.
- Resize and compress before uploading (Section 11).

Templates: a smart shortcut

Almost every platform offers professional templates (themes). Choose one close to what you need, then change only the colours, fonts, photos and words. A well-chosen template, customised with real content, often looks better than a costly custom design that was never finished.

In Mauritius: think about your audience's reality: many visitors will be on a phone, outdoors, on mobile data. High contrast, large text and light pages work better than dark, heavy designs with videos playing in the background.

SECTION 9

Working with a web designer or agency

Many businesses hire a freelancer or agency to build the site. A clear brief and a few simple rules avoid most disappointments.

What to put in your brief

Section	Content
The business	What you do, where, for whom, your competitors and what makes you different
Goal and KPIs	The website's main job and how success will be measured
Pages and features	Your sitemap; forms, booking, online payment, languages, blog
Content	Who writes the texts and provides the photos, and by when
Look and feel	3 websites you like and why; your brand colours, fonts and logo
Technical needs	Platform preference, GA4 and GTM installation, key events, SEO basics, speed targets
Budget and timeline	Your range and launch date
After launch	Training, maintenance, updates, support and who pays for what

Questions to ask before you sign

1. Can I see 3 websites you built recently, and talk to one client?
2. Which platform will you use, and can I edit texts, photos and prices myself afterwards?
3. Will the domain, hosting and all accounts be in my business's name?
4. What exactly is included: number of pages, revisions, languages, SEO basics, GA4/GTM setup, training?
5. What are the yearly running costs after launch (hosting, licences, plugins, maintenance)?
6. How do you make the site fast and mobile-friendly? What PageSpeed result can we expect?
7. What happens if I want to change provider later? Will I get all files and logins?

Red flags

Red flag	Why it matters
The domain or hosting will be in the provider's name	You don't own your website and can lose it
"We guarantee page 1 on Google"	Nobody can guarantee rankings
No written quote or scope	Disagreements on what was included
You can't edit anything yourself	Every small change costs time and money
No mention of mobile, speed or tracking	You may get a pretty site that doesn't perform

Before final payment: run the launch checklist (Section 17) and the capstone audit (Section 29) on the new site, on your own phone.

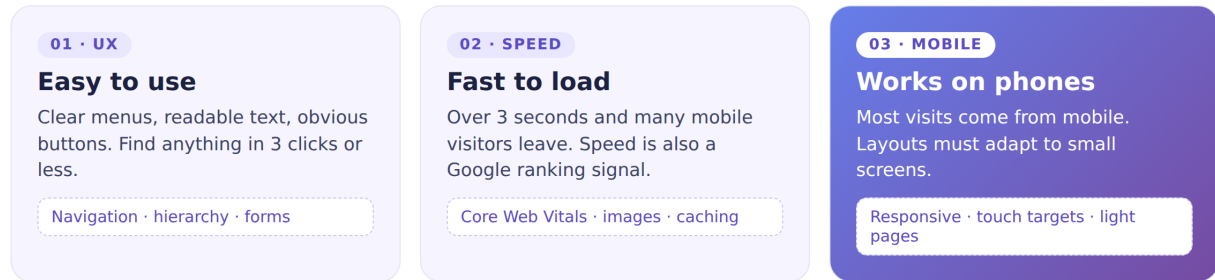
PART B

A website that works

UX, speed, mobile, conversion,
SEO, security and upkeep

The three essentials

What every great website does well, for visitors and for Google



The three essentials from the class. The next three sections take them one by one.

SECTION 10

UX: user experience

User experience (UX) is how easy and pleasant your website is to use. Good UX is invisible: people find what they need, understand it and act, without thinking about the website itself.

1 · Navigation and structure

- A simple menu with 5–7 items, using words customers use ("Cakes", "Prices", "Delivery"), not internal jargon.
- Logo at top left linking to the home page; phone or WhatsApp at top right.
- Everything important reachable in 3 clicks or fewer; breadcrumbs on bigger sites (Home > Cakes > Birthday).
- A search box if you have many products or articles.
- A helpful 404 page ("Page not found") with links back to the main sections.

2 · Visual hierarchy

Visual hierarchy guides the eye to what matters first: the headline, then the key benefit, then the button.

- **Size and weight:** the most important text is the biggest and boldest.
- **Contrast:** dark text on a light background (or the reverse) that is easy to read in sunlight on a phone.
- **White space:** generous spacing makes a page feel clear and premium; clutter feels cheap.
- **Readable type:** at least 16 px body text on mobile, short line lengths, 2–3 fonts maximum.
- **Consistent colours:** one accent colour for all buttons so people learn what is clickable.
- **F and Z patterns:** people scan the top and left first; put key information and the main button there.

3 · Friction and forms

Every extra step or field is a reason to give up. Reduce friction:

- Ask only what you need (name + phone or email is often enough for a first enquiry).
- Label fields clearly, show helpful error messages ("Please enter an 8-digit mobile or 7-digit landline number"), keep entered data when there is an error.
- Use the right keyboard on mobile (number pad for phone fields) and allow autofill.

- Button labels that say what happens: "Send my order" instead of "Submit".
- Offer alternatives: WhatsApp, phone, form. Different people prefer different channels.

Accessibility: websites for everyone

Accessible websites work for people with visual, hearing, motor or cognitive difficulties, and they are usually easier for everyone. Basics: alt text on images, enough colour contrast, text you can enlarge, links and buttons that make sense out of context ("Download the menu" not "Click here"), captions on videos, and a site you can use with the keyboard.

Tip: ask someone who has never seen your site to complete one task on their phone ("order a cake for Saturday") while you watch silently. Where they hesitate is where your UX needs work. Five people find most problems.

SECTION 11

Page speed

Speed is a conversion lever. Every extra second of loading time costs visitors, rankings and revenue, especially on mobile data.

Core Web Vitals: Google's speed and stability scores

Measured on real visits; aim for "Good" on mobile

LCP
Largest Contentful Paint
 How fast the main content (big image or headline) appears.
 Good: 2.5 s or less

INP
Interaction to Next Paint
 How fast the page reacts when someone taps or clicks.
 Good: 200 ms or less

CLS
Cumulative Layout Shift
 Whether the page jumps around while loading.
 Good: 0.1 or less

How to measure speed (free)

Tool	What it shows
PageSpeed Insights (pagespeed.web.dev)	Core Web Vitals from real Chrome users (when available) plus a lab test and a list of fixes, for mobile and desktop
Google Search Console → Core Web Vitals	Which groups of pages on your site are Good, Need improvement or Poor
Your own phone on mobile data	The most honest test: what a customer in Curepipe actually experiences

Quick wins that fix most speed problems

Problem	Fix
Huge images straight from a phone or camera (3–8 MB)	Resize to the display size and compress (Squoosh, TinyPNG); use WebP; aim for under 200 KB per image; WebP is a modern, lighter image format
Everything loads at once	Lazy-load images and videos below the fold (load them only when the visitor scrolls down to them)
Slow or overloaded hosting	Better hosting or a managed platform; caching (saving ready-made copies of pages) and a CDN (a network of servers that delivers your files from nearer the visitor)
Too many plugins, apps and scripts	Remove what you don't use: chat widgets, sliders, trackers
Videos uploaded to the site itself	Host on YouTube or Vimeo and embed
Heavy fonts	Use 1–2 web fonts with only the weights you need

Don't chase a perfect 100 score. Aim for "Good" Core Web Vitals and a site that feels fast on a phone. A beautiful page that loads in 2 seconds beats a blank page that scores 100.

SECTION 12

Mobile-first design

Most visits now come from smartphones, and Google uses the mobile version of your site for ranking. A site that breaks on mobile breaks your business.

Principle	What it means in practice
Responsive layout	The same site adapts to phone, tablet and desktop: columns stack, no horizontal scrolling, no pinching to zoom
Touch targets	Buttons and links at least 44×44 px with space between them, so thumbs don't hit the wrong one
Thumb zone	Main buttons where the thumb reaches easily: bottom and centre of the screen; a sticky "Call / WhatsApp" bar works well
Short and scannable	Shorter paragraphs, collapsible FAQs, key info at the top
Mobile performance	Smaller images, fewer scripts, fast hosting: mobile networks are less forgiving
Tap-to-act	Phone numbers that dial (tel: links), WhatsApp links (wa.me/230...), addresses that open Google Maps
No intrusive pop-ups	Full-screen pop-ups on mobile frustrate visitors and Google discourages them

How to test

1. Open your site on 2–3 different phones (Android and iPhone, small and large screens).
2. In Chrome on a computer: right-click → Inspect → toggle the device toolbar to preview phone sizes.
3. Complete the main task (order, book, contact) using only your thumb.
4. Check forms: does the right keyboard appear? Does autofill work?
5. Check Search Console and PageSpeed Insights for mobile issues.

In Mauritius: a WhatsApp button is often the single most effective conversion feature on a Mauritian website, because customers are used to ordering and asking questions on WhatsApp. Use a click-to-chat link like **`https://wa.me/2305XXXXXXX?text=Hello%20I%20would%20like%20to%20order`** (number in international format without + or spaces) and track clicks in GA4 (Section 23).

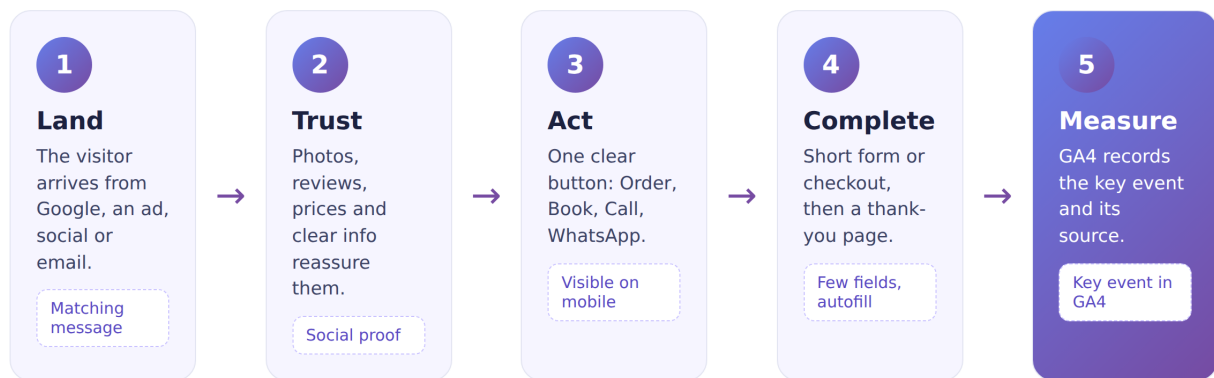
SECTION 13

Conversion essentials

A **conversion** is any action you want visitors to take: an order, a booking, a form, a call, a WhatsApp message. **Conversion rate optimisation (CRO)** means improving the website so more visitors take that action.

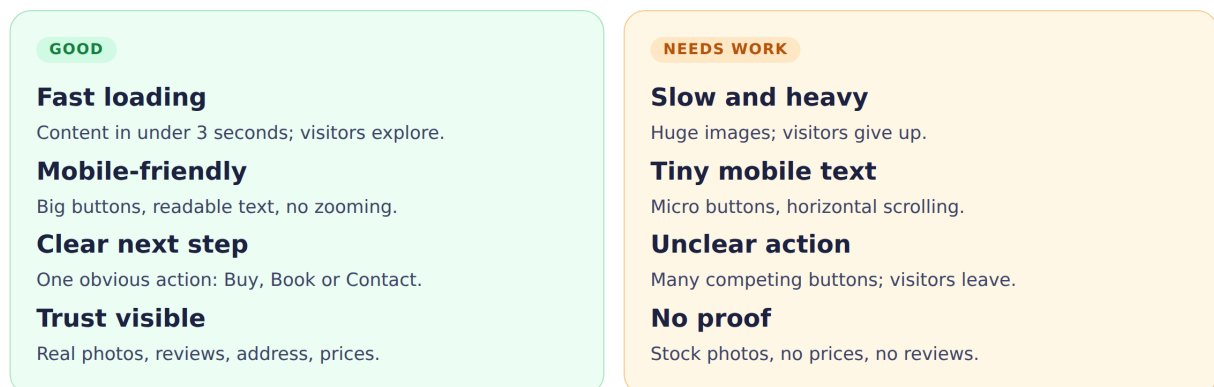
The conversion path on a website

Every step must be easy, or people drop off



Good website vs website that needs work

Spot the difference in 10 seconds



The conversion checklist

- ☐ One clear main call to action per page, repeated at the top, middle and end
- ☐ Buttons that look like buttons, in one accent colour, with action words ("Book my table")
- ☐ Prices or "from" prices visible: hidden prices create doubt and phone calls
- ☐ Trust signals next to the button: reviews, ratings, number of customers, guarantees, secure payment logos

- ☐ Real photos of products, premises and team
- ☐ Contact options visible on every page: phone, WhatsApp, email, address
- ☐ Short forms with autofill; guest checkout for shops
- ☐ Delivery fees, timings and return policy shown before checkout (no surprise costs)
- ☐ A thank-you page after each form, which also lets you track the conversion
- ☐ Landing pages that match the ad: same offer, same words, same image

Test, don't guess

When traffic allows, test one change at a time (headline, button text, photo, form length) and compare conversion rates in GA4 over a few weeks. Small sites can compare "before" and "after" periods of similar length; larger sites can use A/B testing tools.

Tip: look at your own site as a first-time visitor on a phone and ask three questions: What is this? Why should I trust it? What do I do next? If any answer takes more than 5 seconds, fix that first.

SECTION 14

E-commerce and booking essentials

Selling or taking bookings online adds a few extra building blocks. Each one is a place where customers can drop off, so each one deserves attention.

Product pages

- Clear product name and price (in rupees), with what's included.
- Several real photos from different angles, zoom on mobile, and a short video if possible.
- Key details as bullets: size, material, flavours, delivery time, stock status.
- Reviews and ratings for the product.
- A prominent "Add to cart" or "Order" button above the fold on mobile.
- Delivery fee, delivery areas and return policy visible **before** checkout.

Cart and checkout

Good practice	Why
Guest checkout (no forced account creation)	Account creation is one of the top reasons for abandoned carts
Few fields, autofill, mobile keyboards	Every field removed can lift conversions
Total price including delivery shown early	Surprise costs at the last step kill sales
Several payment options	Cards via a local gateway, bank transfer, payment on delivery, PayPal if relevant
Trust signals	Secure payment logos, HTTPS, contact details, returns policy
Clear confirmation	Thank-you page and email with order details and next steps

Booking sites (hotels, guesthouses, restaurants, salons)

- Show real availability and prices; let people choose dates without calling.
- Explain policies clearly: deposit, cancellation, check-in times.
- Send automatic confirmation and reminder emails or WhatsApp messages.

- For hotels and guesthouses: a "Book direct" benefit (best price, free breakfast, late check-out) to compete with booking platforms that charge commissions.
- Track each booking step in GA4 to find where people give up.

After the sale

Ask for a review a few days later, offer a reason to come back (loyalty discount, birthday reminder), and add buyers to your email or WhatsApp list with their consent. Retaining a customer is usually much cheaper than finding a new one (Week 1, loyalty stage).

Tip: track e-commerce events (view_item, add_to_cart, begin_checkout, purchase) from day one. Shopify, WooCommerce and most platforms can send them to GA4 automatically, and they power the funnel in Section 22.

SECTION 15

Website SEO basics

Week 3 covers SEO in depth. When you build or redesign a website, these foundations must be in place from day one, because they are much harder to fix later.

Element	Good practice
Page titles	Unique for every page, main keyword first, about 50–60 characters
Meta descriptions	Unique, benefit + call to action, about 150–160 characters
Headings	One H1 per page with the main topic; H2s for sections
URLs	Short and readable: /birthday-cakes, not /page?id=123
Images	Descriptive file names and alt text; compressed
Internal links	Link related pages with clear words ("see our delivery zones")
Sitemap and indexing	XML sitemap (a file listing your pages for Google) submitted in Google Search Console; important pages not blocked
Speed and mobile	Sections 11 and 12: they affect rankings and conversions
Languages	Separate EN and FR pages (not mixed on one page), linked with hreflang tags (code that tells Google which language each page is in)
Redesigns	Keep old URLs or set up permanent (301) redirects that send old addresses to the new pages, or you lose your rankings
Local business details	Same name, address and phone as on your Google Business Profile

Connect Google Search Console on launch day (search.google.com/search-console): it shows which searches bring visitors, which pages are indexed and any problems. Link it to GA4 so search data appears next to your website data.

AI tools for websites

AI tools can speed up website work a lot, as long as a human checks everything. Use them as an assistant, not as the author.

Task	How AI helps	What you must still do
Writing page copy	Drafts headlines, descriptions, FAQs in English and French from your notes	Add real facts, prices and tone of voice; check accuracy
SEO basics	Suggests titles, meta descriptions, headings and FAQ questions	Check keywords in Google (Week 3), keep it natural
Images	Removes backgrounds, enhances product photos, creates simple illustrations (e.g. in Canva)	Prefer real photos of your products and team
Website builders	Some builders generate a first version of a site from a few questions	Replace generic text and images; check structure and speed
Customer service	Chatbots answer common questions on the site or WhatsApp	Give accurate information; offer a human contact
Analysis	Explains GA4 numbers, suggests hypotheses, writes report summaries	Verify numbers in GA4; never paste personal data

A simple prompt to draft a page

Act as a website copywriter for a small business in Mauritius.
 Business: Lakaz Gato, custom cake shop in Rose Hill, delivery in Plaines Wilhems.
 Audience: parents organising birthdays, mostly on mobile, English and French.
 Write the "Birthday cakes" page: headline, 3 benefits, what's included, price ranges (from Rs 1,200), how to order in 4 steps, 5 FAQs, and a call to action.
 Tone: warm, simple, no jargon. Keep paragraphs to 2 sentences.

Check everything AI writes: it can invent facts, prices, reviews or legal wording. Never publish fake reviews or testimonials, and don't paste customers' personal data into AI tools. Week 13 covers AI for content in depth.

Making your website ready for AI search

AI assistants such as Google AI Overviews and ChatGPT build answers from web pages. Clear pages with answer-first FAQs, accurate details (prices, hours, address) and consistent information across the web make it more likely your business is understood and mentioned. Week 3 explains how, under AEO (Answer Engine Optimisation) and GEO (Generative Engine Optimisation).

Security, legal and upkeep

A website is not a one-off project. Like a shop, it needs to be secure, legally compliant and maintained.

Security basics

- HTTPS (SSL certificate) on every page.
- Strong, unique passwords and two-step verification on the hosting, CMS, domain and Google accounts.
- Each person has their own login with the right access level; remove people who leave.
- Keep the CMS, theme and plugins updated (WordPress especially); delete unused plugins.
- Automatic daily or weekly backups stored outside the website server, and test that you can restore them.
- Spam protection on forms (e.g. reCAPTCHA or a hidden "honeypot" field).

Legal basics in Mauritius

Topic	What to do
Personal data	The Data Protection Act 2017 applies when you collect names, emails, phone numbers or other personal data. Publish a clear privacy policy: what you collect, why, how long you keep it, who you share it with and how people can ask to access or delete their data. Businesses that process personal data as controllers (and processors) must register with the Data Protection Office, and the registration is renewed every 3 years.
Consent and cookies	Ask for consent before adding people to marketing lists. If you use analytics and advertising cookies, explain them and offer a choice; this is essential if you target visitors from Europe (GDPR).
Business identity	Show the legal business name, BRN, address and contact details.
Online sales	Clear prices, delivery terms, cancellation and returns policy, payment security.
Images and content	Use your own photos or properly licensed images; don't copy competitors' text.

This is general information, not legal advice. For specific situations, consult the Data Protection Office or a legal professional.

The website maintenance calendar

How often	Task
Weekly	Check forms and WhatsApp links work; answer enquiries; update offers
Monthly	Updates and backups; review GA4 and Search Console; fix broken links; update photos, prices and hours
Quarterly	Speed and mobile check; review the top 10 pages and improve one; check legal pages
Yearly	Renew domain and hosting; review the whole site against business goals; refresh design if needed

Website launch checklist

- ☐ All pages proofread in every language; prices, hours and contact details correct
- ☐ Every form, button, phone and WhatsApp link tested on mobile and desktop

- ☐ HTTPS everywhere; the http and www versions redirect to one address
- ☐ Titles, descriptions, H1s and image alt text in place
- ☐ Privacy policy, terms and (for shops) returns policy published
- ☐ GA4 installed and recording (Realtime), key events set up and tested
- ☐ Google Tag Manager installed (if used) and published
- ☐ Search Console verified and sitemap submitted
- ☐ Google Business Profile updated with the website link
- ☐ Old URLs redirected (for redesigns); backups running

PART C

Measuring with GA4

Google Analytics 4: setup, metrics,
reports, key events and funnels

Meet Google Analytics 4

Google Analytics 4 (GA4) is Google's free analytics platform. It tells you **who** visits your website, **where** they come from and **what** they do there, so you can decide where to spend time and money.

What changed	Why it matters
GA4 replaced Universal Analytics, which stopped collecting data in July 2023	GA4 is now the only Google Analytics product; old tutorials about "goals" and the old bounce-rate definition may be outdated
Everything is an event	Page views, clicks, scrolls, downloads and purchases are all events, which gives a much richer picture than page views alone
Web and app in one property	If you have a website and a mobile app, you see the whole customer journey in one place
Privacy-focused	Built for a world with fewer cookies; uses modelling to fill gaps

GA4 is built on events

Every action is an event; the important ones become key events

AUTOMATIC

Collected for you

page_view · session_start · first_visit · user_engagement

ENHANCED MEASUREMENT

One switch in settings

scroll · click (outbound) · file_download · video_start · form_start · view_search_results

CUSTOM / RECOMMENDED

You set them up

generate_lead · whatsapp_click · book_table · add_to_cart · purchase

KEY EVENTS

What matters to the business

Mark the important events as key events (formerly "conversions").

How GA4 is organised

Level	What it is	Example
Account	Your organisation (top level)	Lakaz Gato Ltd
Property	One website and/or app you measure; has its own reports, settings and time zone	lakazgato.mu
Data stream	The source of data inside a property: Web, iOS app or Android app	Web stream: https://lakazgato.mu (Measurement ID G-XXXXXXX)

What GA4 can and cannot tell you

GA4 can tell you...	GA4 cannot tell you...
How many people visited and how often	Who a specific person is (names, emails): that would break privacy rules
Which channels bring visitors and customers	What happened offline (phone orders, shop visits) unless you import it
Which pages and content perform best	Why people left: combine with UX tests and feedback
Where people drop off in a funnel	Perfectly exact numbers: ad blockers and consent choices hide some visits

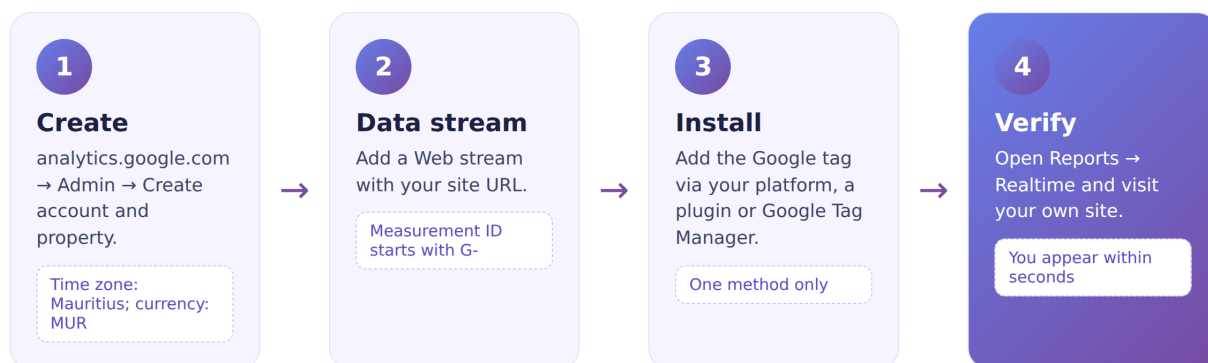
SECTION 19

Setting up GA4

The basic setup is free and takes about 15 minutes. You don't need a developer if your website platform has a GA4 integration.

Setting up GA4 in four steps

About 15 minutes, no developer needed for the basics



Step by step

1. Go to **analytics.google.com** and sign in with the business's Google account.
2. Click **Admin** (gear icon) → **Create** → **Account**; name it after the business. Then create a **Property**: name it after the website, set the time zone to **Mauritius** and the currency to **Mauritian rupee (MUR)**. Answer the business questions.
3. Choose **Web** as the platform, enter your website URL and a stream name. Keep **Enhanced measurement** switched on.
4. Copy your **Measurement ID** (starts with **G-**).
5. Install the tag, using **one** method only: your platform's built-in GA4 field (Wix, Shopify, Squarespace), a WordPress plugin (e.g. Site Kit by Google), pasting the Google tag code in the site's <head>, or Google Tag Manager (Section 23).
6. Open **Reports** → **Realtime** and visit your own site on your phone: you should appear within a few seconds.

Five settings to change on day one

Setting	Where	Why
Data retention: 14 months	Admin → Data collection and modification → Data retention	The default keeps detailed data for only 2 months in explorations
Internal traffic filter	Admin → Data streams → your stream → Configure tag settings → Show more → Define internal traffic (add your IP); then Admin → Data collection and modification → Data filters → Internal Traffic → change Testing to Active. Once active, excluded data is gone for good, so test first.	Stops your own and your team's visits from inflating the numbers
Link Google Search Console	Admin → Product links → Search Console links	See search queries next to website behaviour
Link Google Ads (if used)	Admin → Product links → Google Ads links	Import key events into Ads and see ad performance in GA4
Users and access	Admin → Account access management	Give your agency or trainer the right role (Viewer, Analyst, Editor); don't share your password

Install GA4 once. If GA4 is installed directly on the site **and** through Google Tag Manager, every event is counted twice and your reports look twice as good as reality. Check with Tag Assistant (tagassistant.google.com) that the tag fires once per page.

Tracking your campaigns with UTM links

GA4 recognises Google and most social platforms automatically, but for emails, WhatsApp messages, QR codes and some ads you should add **UTM parameters** to your links, so visits are credited to the right campaign.

Parameter	Meaning	Example
utm_source	Where the traffic comes from	newsletter, whatsapp, facebook, flyer
utm_medium	The type of channel	email, social, cpc (paid clicks), referral, display
utm_campaign	The campaign name	fete-des-meres-2026
<pre>https://lakazgato.mu/fete-des-meres ?utm_source=newsletter &utm_medium=email &utm_campaign=fete-des-meres-2026 (written here on 4 lines; in practice it is one single link)</pre>		

Use Google's free Campaign URL Builder (search "GA4 campaign URL builder"), keep everything lowercase, and use the same names every time.

SECTION 20

Metrics and reports

GA4 has hundreds of numbers. Start with the few that tell you whether the website is healthy and whether it brings business.

The four metrics that matter most

Understand these and you understand your visitors

USERS
How many people
Unique visitors in a period, counted once per device or signed-in user.
Audience size

SESSIONS
How many visits
A visit; it ends after 30 minutes of inactivity. One user can have many.
Return visits

ENGAGEMENT RATE
How many visits mattered
Sessions that lasted 10+ seconds, had 2+ page views or a key event.
Quality of traffic

KEY EVENTS
How many results
Actions that matter: leads, bookings, purchases, WhatsApp clicks.
Business outcomes

Metric	Definition	How to read it
Users (active users)	People who visited and engaged during the period	Your audience size; compare with last month
New users	People visiting for the first time	Shows reach of new campaigns
Sessions	Visits; a session ends after 30 minutes of inactivity (adjustable)	Sessions higher than users = people come back
Engaged sessions	Sessions that lasted longer than 10 seconds, or had a key event, or had 2+ page views	Real interest, not accidental clicks
Engagement rate	$\text{Engaged sessions} \div \text{sessions}$	Quality of traffic; compare channels and pages
Bounce rate	Sessions that were not engaged ($100\% - \text{engagement rate}$)	High on a landing page = message or speed problem
Average engagement time	Time the page was actually in focus on screen	Is the content being read?
Views	Page or screen views	Popular content
Key events	Important actions you marked (lead, booking, purchase)	Business results
Session key event rate	$\text{Sessions with a key event} \div \text{sessions}$	Your website conversion rate

The GA4 interface

Section	Use it for
Home	Quick overview: users, top channels, trends. Start here.
Reports	Ready-made reports: Realtime, Acquisition, Engagement, Monetization, Retention, User attributes, Tech
Explore	Your own analyses: free-form tables, funnel explorations, path explorations, segments
Advertising	Attribution and conversion paths across channels
Admin	Settings, data streams, users, links, key events

The reports you will use most

Question	Report
Where do visitors come from?	Reports → Acquisition → Traffic acquisition (by session default channel group, i.e. GA4's standard channels such as Organic Search, Paid Social, Email, Direct; or source / medium)
Which channels bring new people?	Reports → Acquisition → User acquisition
Which pages are most popular and engaging?	Reports → Engagement → Pages and screens
Which pages do people land on first?	Reports → Engagement → Landing page
Which actions happen and how often?	Reports → Engagement → Events (and Key events)
What do online shoppers buy?	Reports → Monetization → Ecommerce purchases
Phone or computer? Which browser?	Reports → Tech → Tech details

Reading a report: from numbers to a decision

Step	Example
The numbers	100 users, 150 sessions, 65% engagement rate, 8 conversions (key events)
The calculation	Conversion rate = $8 \div 150$ sessions = about 5%; $150 \div 100 = 1.5$ visits per user; 35% of sessions (about 52) were not engaged
The insight	People come back (1.5 visits each) and 5% convert, which is decent. But about a third leave without engaging
The decision	Check which landing pages have the lowest engagement rate; test speed on mobile and make the headline and button clearer there

Tip: always compare: this month vs last month, this channel vs another, mobile vs desktop. A number alone means little; a change or a difference tells a story.

Key events and conversions

A **conversion** is any visitor action that is valuable to your business. In GA4 these are called **key events** (Google renamed "conversions" to key events in 2024; the word "conversions" is still used in Google Ads).

Type	Examples	Why track it
Lead	Contact form, quote request, newsletter sign-up, brochure download, demo booking	Each one is a sales opportunity
Sale	Online purchase, paid booking, subscription	Directly tied to revenue: proves marketing ROI (return on investment)
Contact	Click on phone number, WhatsApp button, email link, "Get directions"	Very common for Mauritian businesses
Micro-conversion	Video watched, 75% scroll on a pricing page, product added to cart	Early signals of interest, useful for optimisation

Three types of tracking

Tracking type	Best for	How
Key events (lead-based)	Service businesses, B2B (business-to-business), bookings by form	Mark form submissions, WhatsApp and phone clicks as key events
Custom events	Engagement insights	Video plays, scroll depth, button clicks via GTM or GA4
E-commerce tracking	Online shops	Recommended events: view_item, add_to_cart, begin_checkout, purchase (with value and currency), plus refund; Shopify, WooCommerce and most platforms send them through an integration

Setting up a key event in three steps

1. **Define the action precisely:** "clicked the WhatsApp button on any page" or "submitted the order form (thank-you page viewed)". Vague tracking gives vague reports.
2. **Create the event:** in GA4 (Admin → Events → Create event, e.g. page_view where page location contains /merci) or in Google Tag Manager (Section 23). Use clear lowercase names with underscores: whatsapp_click, order_form_submit, book_table.
3. **Mark it as a key event:** Admin → Key events → New key event (or star the event in the Events list). It now appears in key event reports and can be imported into Google Ads.

Event naming plan (example)

Event name	Fires when...	Key event?
whatsapp_click	Someone clicks a wa.me link	Yes
phone_click	Someone clicks a tel: link	Yes
order_form_submit	The order thank-you page is viewed	Yes
generate_lead	The contact form is submitted	Yes
file_download	The menu PDF is downloaded (enhanced measurement)	No
scroll	90% of a page is scrolled (enhanced measurement)	No

Start small: pick 1-3 key events that really matter to the business. Tracking everything from day one creates confusion. Then **test each one:** submit your own form, click your own button and check that it appears in Realtime and in **DebugView** (Admin → DebugView: shows events live while you test, for example with Google Tag Manager's Preview mode running).

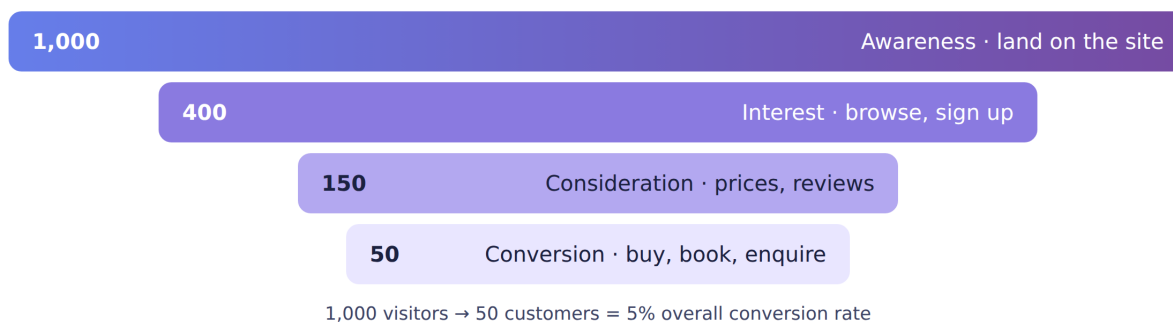
SECTION 22

Funnels and attribution

A **funnel** shows the steps people take from first visit to purchase, and how many drop off at each step. **Attribution** decides which marketing channel gets credit when someone converts.

The website funnel

From first visit to customer: the group narrows at each step

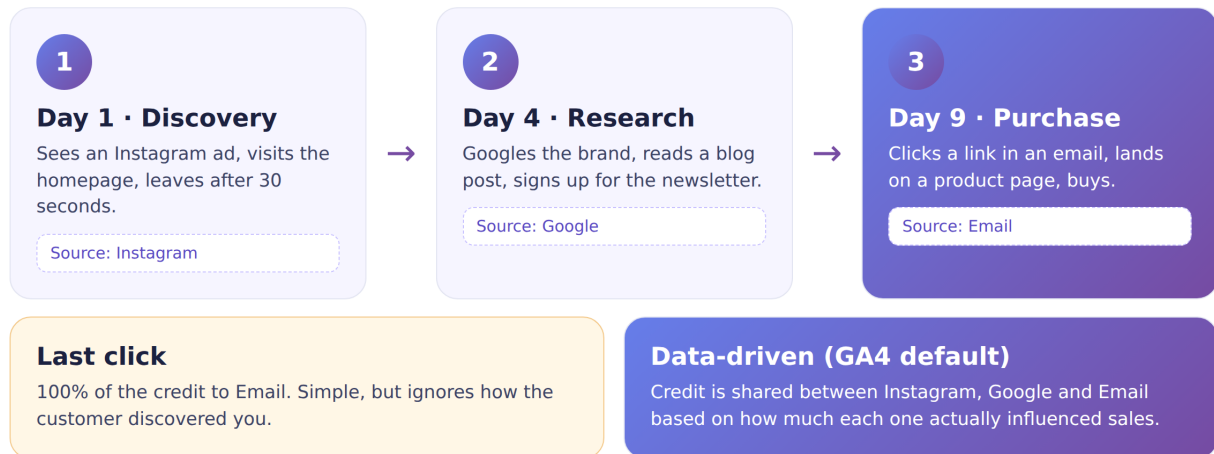


Building a funnel in GA4

1. Go to **Explore** → **Funnel exploration** (or start from Blank and choose the funnel technique).
2. Define the steps, for a shop: view_item → add_to_cart → begin_checkout → purchase. For a lead site: landing_page → pricing_page → form_start → generate_lead.
3. Choose open or closed funnel (closed = people must start at step 1) and a date range.
4. Break down by device or channel to see where the drop is worse.
5. Look at the percentage between each step: the biggest drop is your **bottleneck** (Section 25).

One customer, three channels

Who gets the credit for the sale? That is attribution.



Attribution models

Model	How credit is given	Strength / weakness
First click	100% to the first touchpoint	Values discovery, ignores what convinced the buyer
Last click	100% to the last touchpoint before the conversion	Simple, but unfair to awareness channels like social and video
Data-driven (GA4 default)	Shared across touchpoints based on how much each one actually increases the chance of converting	Fairer and modern; needs enough data

In GA4 you choose the reporting model in Admin → Data display → Attribution settings:

Data-driven (default), **Paid and organic last click** or **Google paid channels last click**. First click is used here only as a concept to understand the journey. To see the real paths customers take, open Advertising → Attribution → **Attribution paths**.

Tip: when a channel looks weak on last click (for example Instagram), check Attribution paths before cutting its budget. It may be the channel that starts most journeys.

PART D

Tags, dashboards, decisions

Google Tag Manager, Data Studio,
clean data and turning numbers into action

Google Tag Manager

Google Tag Manager (GTM) lets you add and manage tracking codes (GA4 events, the Meta Pixel, LinkedIn Insight Tag...) from one dashboard, without editing the website's code each time.

Without GTM	With GTM
You want to track a button click: you ask a developer, the request waits in a queue	Open GTM, click New Tag, choose the GA4 event template
The developer adds code, tests and schedules a release: one to two weeks	Add a trigger for that button, test in Preview mode
Every small change repeats the process	Submit: live in about 5 minutes; change it any time

Google Tag Manager: three building blocks

Install one container, then manage every tracking code from a dashboard

TAGS
What to do
 The tracking code that runs: the Google tag, a GA4 event, the Meta Pixel, LinkedIn Insight.
 The workers

TRIGGERS
When to do it
 The rule that fires the tag: every page view, a click on "Book now", a form submission.
 The "when"

VARIABLES
Extra information
 Details captured with the tag: page URL, button text, order value.
 The "what"

Example: Tag = GA4 event "whatsapp_click" · Trigger = click on a link containing wa.me · Variable = page URL

Setting up your GTM container

1. Go to **tagmanager.google.com** → **Create account**. Name it after the business; country Mauritius.
2. Create a **container** named after the website; target platform **Web**. GTM gives you a container ID starting with **GTM-**.
3. Install the two snippets: one as high as possible in the <head> of every page, one right after the opening <body> tag. WordPress plugins and most platforms have a field for the GTM ID instead.
4. Add the **Google tag**: Tags → New → Google tag → enter your GA4 Measurement ID (G-...) → trigger: **Initialization - All Pages** (or All Pages). Remove any GA4 code installed directly on the site.
5. In **Variables** → **Configure**, enable the built-in click variables: Click Element, Click Classes, Click ID, Click URL, Click Text, and the form variables.

Three basic triggers to start with

Trigger	Fires when	Typical use
Initialization / Page View	A page loads (all pages or specific URLs); Initialization fires first	The Google tag (Initialization – All Pages); a "thank-you page" key event
Click (Just Links / All Elements)	Someone clicks a link or element matching your condition (Click URL contains wa.me, Click Classes contains btn-book...)	WhatsApp, phone, "Book now" buttons
Form Submission	A form is submitted (works with many, not all, form tools)	Contact or quote forms; always test with your own form first

Example: track WhatsApp clicks

1. **Trigger:** New → Click – Just Links → Some link clicks → Click URL contains **wa.me** (add a second trigger for api.whatsapp.com if used).
2. **Tag:** New → Google Analytics: GA4 Event → Measurement ID G-... → Event name **whatsapp_click** → add a parameter link_page = {{Page Path}} → choose the trigger above.
3. **Preview:** click Preview, enter your site URL, click a WhatsApp button and check in Tag Assistant that the tag fired once.
4. **Publish:** Submit → version name "WhatsApp click tracking" → Publish.
5. In GA4, wait for the event to appear (Realtime / DebugView), then mark **whatsapp_click** as a key event.

Never publish blindly. Always use Preview mode, test every trigger, and give each published version a clear name and description. If something breaks, you can roll back to the previous version in one click (Versions).

SECTION 24

Data Studio dashboards

Data Studio (called Looker Studio from 2022 until April 2026, when Google brought back the Data Studio name) is Google's free tool for turning data into clear, shareable dashboards. It connects to GA4, Google Ads, Search Console, Google Sheets, YouTube and hundreds of other sources through connectors.

Your first Data Studio dashboard

One page, five KPIs, always up to date



Illustrative numbers for a fictional business.

Build your first report (under an hour)

1. Open **Data Studio** (search "Google Data Studio"; existing Looker Studio links keep working) → **Blank report**.
2. **Add data:** choose the Google Analytics connector, then your account and property (or the GA4 demo property for practice). Authorise access.
3. Add a **date range control** at the top so viewers can change the period.
4. Add **scorecards** for the headline KPIs: Total users, Sessions, Key events, Session key event rate. Turn on "comparison to previous period".
5. Add a **time series chart** of users (or engagement rate) by date to see trends.
6. Add a **table or bar chart** of sessions and key events by session default channel group, to see which channels deliver.
7. Add a table of the top landing pages with engagement rate and key events.
8. Give it a clear title and date, e.g. "Monthly Marketing KPIs – Lakaz Gato".

The five KPIs for a one-page marketing report

KPI	Chart	Question it answers
1 · Total users	Scorecard with comparison	How many people did we reach this month?
2 · Sessions	Scorecard	How many visits? Higher than users = people return
3 · Conversion rate (session key event rate)	Scorecard	How efficiently do visits become business?
4 · Traffic sources	Pie or bar chart by channel	Where do visitors come from?
5 · Engagement rate over time	Time series	Is the website and content getting better?

Sharing

Click **Share** (top right): invite people by email with view-only access, or create a link. You can also schedule an automatic email delivery (e.g. the first Monday of each month). The data refreshes automatically each time the report opens, so there is no need to export spreadsheets. A dashboard nobody looks at is wasted work: put it where the team already works and review it together every month.

SECTION 25

Clean data and decisions

Bad data leads to bad decisions. A few minutes of "data hygiene" each month saves hours of confusion and wasted budget. Then the real work starts: turning numbers into action.

Common tracking mistakes

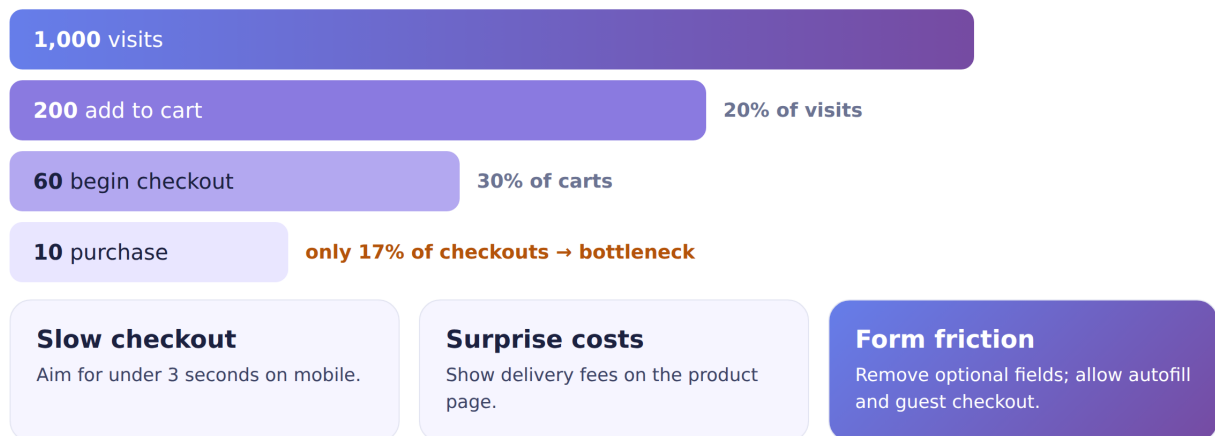
Mistake	What happens	Fix
Counting yourself	Your team's visits inflate traffic and distort rates	Define internal traffic by IP and activate the data filter
Double tagging	GA4 installed directly and via GTM: every event counted twice	One method only; check with Tag Assistant
Untested key events	Reports show 0 leads, or count page reloads as leads	Submit your own form; check Realtime / DebugView
No UTM links	Email and WhatsApp traffic lands in "Direct"	Tag every campaign link with UTMs
Spam and bots	Strange spikes from unknown sources	GA4 excludes known bots automatically; investigate unusual spikes and referrers
Mixed time zone or currency	Daily data and revenue look wrong	Set Mauritius time zone and MUR in the property
Changing the site without checking tags	Tracking silently breaks after a redesign	Re-test all key events after every site change

Monthly hygiene checklist

- ☐ **Sources:** open Traffic acquisition. Do the channels make sense? Any "(not set)" (GA4 couldn't identify the value) or unknown referrers?
- ☐ **Key events:** submit your own form and click your own buttons. Do they appear within a minute?
- ☐ **Internal traffic:** is the filter active and are new office or team IPs included?
- ☐ **Spikes:** any unusual jump in Direct or one country? Investigate before celebrating.
- ☐ **Access:** remove people who no longer need access to GA4, GTM and Data Studio.

Find the bottleneck

The step with the biggest drop is where to focus first



Read the sample data yourself

Google's free **GA4 demo account** (Google Merchandise Store) contains months of real e-commerce data. Access it from Google's help article "Demo account" (support.google.com/analytics/answer/6367342) with any Google account. In the demo: Explore → Funnel exploration → steps View item → Add to cart → Begin checkout → Purchase, and find where the biggest drop happens.

From data to decisions: a monthly routine

Question	Where to look	Possible decision
Which channel brings the most customers (not just visitors)?	Traffic acquisition with key events and conversion rate	Move budget towards the channel with the best cost per key event
Which landing pages lose visitors?	Landing page report: low engagement rate	Improve speed, headline and button on those pages
Where do people drop off?	Funnel exploration	Fix the bottleneck step (delivery fees, form length, checkout speed)
Is mobile worse than desktop?	Tech report or funnel by device	Prioritise mobile UX and speed fixes
Which content attracts people from Google?	Search Console + Pages and screens	Create more content on those topics (Week 4)
Did last month's change work?	Compare periods in Data Studio	Keep, adjust or roll back

The rule: every monthly review should end with 1–3 concrete actions, an owner and a date. Data that doesn't change a decision is just decoration.

Case study: from Facebook page to website in 90 days

A fictional but realistic example that brings the whole guide together: **Lakaz Gato**, a home-based cake business in Rose Hill that took orders only through Facebook and WhatsApp.

The starting point

Situation	Problem
Orders only by Facebook messages and WhatsApp	Same questions answered 20 times a day (prices, delivery, flavours)
Prices not published	Many conversations that never became orders
No website, no analytics	No idea which posts or ads brought customers
Good Google reviews but no Google Business Profile link to orders	Customers found the shop but couldn't order easily

The plan

Weeks	Actions
1-2 · Plan	Goal: 40 website orders/month by month 3. Sitemap of 7 pages, content plan, photos of 30 cakes, price list, delivery zones.
3-4 · Build	Shopify-style small shop or a WordPress site with an order form; WhatsApp button on every page; EN/FR pages; privacy policy.
5 · Measure	GA4 + GTM: key events order_form_submit and whatsapp_click; UTM links in Facebook posts and the newsletter; Search Console.
6 · Launch	Launch checklist; Google Business Profile, Facebook and Instagram bios link to the site; QR code on cake boxes.
7-12 · Improve	Monthly Data Studio review; fix the biggest bottleneck each month; add one helpful page per month.

What the data showed after 90 days (illustrative)

Finding	Decision	Result
70% of visits on mobile; order form had 9 fields	Cut the form to 5 fields, added WhatsApp as an alternative	Form completion rate up
Instagram brought many visitors but few orders; Google brought fewer visitors but the most orders	Kept Instagram for awareness, created pages for "birthday cake rose hill" searches	More orders from search
Big drop between the cake page and the order form	Added delivery fees and order deadline on every cake page	Fewer abandoned orders
The same price and delivery questions were asked every day on WhatsApp	Added a FAQ page and linked it in WhatsApp replies	Fewer repeat questions; hours saved each week

The lesson: the website didn't replace Facebook and WhatsApp; it organised them. Social media created interest, the website answered questions and took orders, and analytics showed where to improve. That is the digital ecosystem from Week 1, working in practice.

Website FAQ for business owners

The questions business owners ask most often when they start working on a website, with short, practical answers.

How much does a website cost?

It varies enormously: from a monthly subscription on a builder you set up yourself, to a custom site built by an agency. Compare at least three written quotes for the same scope, and always ask for the **yearly running costs** (domain, hosting or subscription, plugins/apps, maintenance), not only the build price.

How long does it take?

A simple 5–8 page business site can be live in 2–6 weeks if the content (texts, photos, prices) is ready. E-commerce and booking sites take longer. Missing content is the most common cause of delays.

Can I build it myself?

Yes, with Wix, Squarespace, Shopify or WordPress with a good theme, if you are comfortable with tools like Canva. Use a template, follow Sections 5–13, and get someone experienced to review speed, tracking and SEO before launch.

WordPress or Wix?

Wix (and similar builders) is quicker and simpler for small sites. WordPress is more flexible and powerful for bigger sites, blogs and custom needs, but needs regular updates and good hosting. Shopify is usually the easiest for online shops.

Do I need a blog?

Not on day one. But helpful articles and guides that answer customer questions are one of the best ways to be found on Google and in AI answers (Weeks 3 and 4). Start with an FAQ page, then add one useful article a month.

Do I need both English and French?

If your customers search and read in both languages, yes. Create separate pages for each language rather than mixing them, and translate properly (don't just paste machine translation without checking).

How do I appear on Google?

Connect Google Search Console, submit your sitemap, create a Google Business Profile and build useful pages for what customers search. Week 3 explains SEO step by step.

Why is so much of my traffic "Direct" in GA4?

Visits from WhatsApp, emails, QR codes and apps often have no referrer and land in Direct. Use UTM links (Section 19) for every campaign link you share.

Why don't GA4 numbers match Facebook or Google Ads?

Each platform counts differently: ad platforms count clicks and their own attributed conversions; GA4 counts sessions on your site and shares credit across channels. Ad blockers and consent choices also hide some visits. Compare trends, not exact numbers.

How often should I update my website?

Small updates (offers, photos, prices, hours) as soon as they change; a review of the main pages every quarter; a design refresh every few years or when it no longer reflects the business.

Is a Facebook shop or marketplace enough?

It can be a good start and a useful extra channel, but you don't own the platform or the customer data. A website gives you a stable base that all channels can point to.

What should I track first?

The one or two actions that matter most: an order or booking, and WhatsApp or phone clicks. Get those right, then add more (Section 21).

PART E

Practice

Exercises, capstone,
glossary and checklists

SECTION 28

Website audit toolkit

You don't need paid software to audit a website. These free tools show how fast a site is, whether its tracking works, how Google sees it and whether visitors can trust it. Use them on your own site, on competitors and for the capstone.

The free toolkit. All of these are free, or have a free plan that is enough for a small business.

Tool	What it tells you	How to use it
PageSpeed Insights pagespeed.web.dev	Google's speed score (0-100) and Core Web Vitals (LCP, INP, CLS), with real-user data when the site has enough traffic	Paste the URL, read the Mobile tab first, then the list of opportunities
GTmetrix gtmetrix.com	Grade A-F, fully loaded time, page size and a waterfall chart showing which file slows the page	Free account; open the Waterfall tab to find the heaviest images and scripts
Lighthouse built into Chrome	Scores for performance, accessibility, best practices and SEO, with fixes	Right-click → Inspect → Lighthouse → Analyze page load
WebPageTest webpagetest.org	Tests from other locations and slower connections; filmstrip of how the page appears	Free account; compare a 4G mobile test with desktop
Google Tag Assistant tagassistant.google.com	Which Google tags fire (GA4, Google Ads, GTM) and which events they send	Connect the site, click around, check page_view and key events
GA4 DebugView inside GA4	Events arriving live from your own device while you test	Admin → DebugView, with Tag Assistant or GTM preview connected
Wappalyzer Chrome extension	What a site is built with: CMS, e-commerce platform, analytics, pixels, chat tools	Click the icon on any website, including competitors
Microsoft Clarity clarity.microsoft.com	Free heatmaps and session recordings: where people click, scroll and get stuck	Install on a site you own (via GTM); review recordings of visitors who left
Hotjar hotjar.com	Heatmaps, recordings and on-site surveys	Free plan; same idea as Clarity, on a site you own
Google Search Console search.google.com/search-console	Indexing, search queries, Core Web Vitals and errors, straight from Google	Verify your own site; check Pages and Core Web Vitals monthly
Screaming Frog SEO Spider screamingfrog.co.uk	Crawls a site like Google: broken links, redirects, missing titles and descriptions	Free desktop app, up to 500 URLs per crawl
Ahrefs Webmaster Tools ahrefs.com/webmaster-tools	Site audit and backlinks for a site you own	Free after verifying the site
Rich Results Test search.google.com/test/rich-results	Which structured data (schema) Google finds: LocalBusiness, Hotel, FAQ, Product...	Paste the URL; fix errors in red
WAVE wave.webaim.org	Accessibility errors shown on the page: missing alt text, low contrast, empty links	Paste the URL; aim for 0 errors

Tool	What it tells you	How to use it
SSL Labs ssllabs.com/ssltest	How well HTTPS is set up (grade A+ to F)	Enter the domain; A or A+ is the target
Security Headers securityheaders.com	Whether the server sends basic security headers	Quick grade; share the result with your web developer
Similarweb similarweb.com (free extension)	Rough traffic estimates and traffic sources for any site	Useful for competitors; treat numbers as estimates only

Reading the scores

Measure	Good	Needs work	Poor
PageSpeed / Lighthouse score	90–100	50–89	0–49
Largest Contentful Paint (LCP): main content visible	≤ 2.5 s	2.5–4 s	> 4 s
Interaction to Next Paint (INP): reacts to taps and clicks	≤ 200 ms	200–500 ms	> 500 ms
Cumulative Layout Shift (CLS): page jumps while loading	≤ 0.1	0.1–0.25	> 0.25
WAVE accessibility errors	0	1–5	More than 5
SSL Labs grade	A or A+	B	C or lower

A 30-minute audit routine

1. **Speed:** PageSpeed Insights on mobile, then GTmetrix to see which files are heaviest.
2. **Tracking:** Wappalyzer to see what is installed, then Tag Assistant to check that GA4 really fires.
3. **Google's view:** Rich Results Test on the home page; on your own site, Search Console → Pages.
4. **Health:** Screaming Frog for broken links and missing titles (small sites only).
5. **Trust and access:** SSL Labs, Security Headers and WAVE.
6. **Decide:** list every problem, then pick the 3 fixes with the biggest impact on customers. Speed and broken booking or contact paths usually come first.

In Mauritius: lab tests run from servers abroad, so their loading times can differ from what a customer in Port Louis or Curepipe sees. Always finish with your own phone on 4G, outside Wi-Fi.

Tip: run speed tests two or three times and keep the middle result: scores move a little from one test to the next.

Be a good neighbour: heatmap tools (Clarity, Hotjar) and Search Console only go on sites you own or manage. When you crawl someone else's site with Screaming Frog, keep it small and don't run it repeatedly.

Practise it: tab 5 of the Week 2 Excel exercise (Module 2, exercise 2.4) is a guided audit with these tools.

Exercises and capstone

These exercises match the class sessions. Submit your work on the learning platform (Module 2 exercises 2.1–2.4), and use the capstone to bring the whole week together.

Exercise A · Explore the GA4 demo account (30 min)

1. **Acquisition:** which channel brings the most users? Which brings the most key events or purchases? Is it the same channel?
2. **Engagement:** which page has the highest engagement rate? What makes it work?
3. **Monetization:** what are the top products by revenue?
4. **Funnel:** build View item → Add to cart → Begin checkout → Purchase. Where is the biggest drop?

Exercise B · Build a one-page Data Studio report (45 min)

Connect the GA4 demo property and build the five-KPI report from Section 24. Title it with the month, share it view-only with your trainer and paste the link on the platform.

Exercise C · Set up GA4 and GTM (Module 2 exercises 2.1 and 2.2)

Create a GA4 property "Learning Property – [Your Name]" with a Web data stream, note your Measurement ID (G-...), create a GTM Web container, note the container ID (GTM-...) and explore both interfaces. Submit screenshots.

Exercise D · Event tracking plan (Module 2 exercise 2.3)

For five events (button click, form submission, video play, scroll depth, PDF download) document: the trigger, the parameters captured, the GTM trigger needed and the GA4 event name. Use the naming plan in Section 21 as a model.

Exercise E · Website & Analytics in Excel (Module 2 exercise 2.4)

Download the Excel file from the platform: clean 25 campaign links with UTM rules, calculate GA4 metrics by channel, analyse a booking funnel, build a pivot table on three months of data and audit a real website with the toolkit in Section 28. Upload your completed file for personalised feedback.

Capstone · Website audit and growth plan

Choose a real Mauritian business website (yours, your employer's or a brand you know). Score each area from 1 (poor) to 5 (excellent) and write your top fixes.

Area	What to check	Score /5	Top fix
First impression	5-second test on mobile: what, why trust, what next?		
UX	Menu, hierarchy, readability, forms		
Speed	PageSpeed Insights mobile: LCP, INP, CLS (tools in Section 28)		
Mobile	Touch targets, WhatsApp/call buttons, no horizontal scroll		

Area	What to check	Score /5	Top fix
Conversion	Clear CTA, prices, trust signals, short forms		
Content and SEO basics	Titles, headings, useful pages, EN/FR		
Security and legal	HTTPS, privacy policy, business details		
Tracking	GA4/GTM installed? Key events? (check with Tag Assistant if allowed)		
Total		/40	

Then write a **one-page growth plan**: (1) the website's main goal and KPI, (2) your top 5 fixes in order of impact, (3) the key events to track, (4) the Data Studio dashboard you would build, and (5) how you will review results every month.

Plan your own website

Use these worksheets for your capstone or for a real business. Print them or copy them into a document.

Worksheet 1 · Goal, audience and KPIs

Question	Your answer
Business and location	
The website's main job (one sentence)	
SMART objective (Week 1)	
Main audience: who, device, language	
Top 5 questions customers ask before buying	
Key events to track in GA4 (1-3)	

Worksheet 2 · Sitemap

Main menu item	Sub-pages	Goal of the page	Main keyword

Worksheet 3 · Page content plan

Page	Headline	Key message	Content and photos needed	Call to action	Proof

Worksheet 4 · Tracking plan

Action	Event name	GTM trigger	Key event?	Tested on
WhatsApp click	whatsapp_click	Click URL contains wa.me	Yes	
Order form sent	order_form_submit	Page view: /merci	Yes	

Worksheet 5 · Monthly review

KPI	Last month	This month	Change	Why?
Users				
Sessions				
Engagement rate				
Key events				
Conversion rate				
Top channel				

Actions for next month (owner and date):

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.

Glossary and checklists

Term	Meaning
Domain / DNS	Your web address / the settings that connect it to your site and email
Hosting	The server that stores and delivers your website
SSL / HTTPS	Encryption that secures the connection; shows the padlock
CMS	Content management system: software to build and edit a website (WordPress, Wix, Shopify)
Landing page	A page built for one campaign and one action
Sitemap	The structure of a website's pages (also an XML file for Google)
Wireframe	A simple layout sketch of a page
UX	User experience: how easy and pleasant a site is to use
CTA	Call to action: the button or link you want people to click
CRO	Conversion rate optimisation: improving the site so more visitors act
Core Web Vitals	Google's speed and stability metrics: LCP, INP, CLS
Responsive design	A layout that adapts to any screen size
GA4	Google Analytics 4, Google's analytics platform
Property / data stream	A measured website or app / the source of its data (web, iOS, Android)
Measurement ID	The GA4 web stream ID, starting with G-
Event / key event	Any tracked action / an action marked as important (formerly "conversion")
Users / sessions	People / visits
Engagement rate	Share of sessions that were engaged (10+ seconds, 2+ pages or a key event)
Bounce rate	Share of sessions that were not engaged
UTM parameters	Tags added to links to identify source, medium and campaign
Funnel / bottleneck	The steps to conversion / the step with the biggest drop
Attribution	How credit for a conversion is shared between channels
GTM: tag, trigger, variable	The code to run / when to run it / extra information it captures
Container	The GTM box that holds all your tags (ID starts with GTM-)
Data Studio	Google's free dashboard and reporting tool (called Looker Studio 2022–2026)
Internal traffic filter	A GA4 filter that excludes your own team's visits
DebugView	A GA4 screen that shows events live while you test tracking
KPI	Key performance indicator: a number that shows progress towards an objective
BRN	Business Registration Number, issued when a business is registered in Mauritius

Week 2 checklist

- ☐ I can explain why a business needs its own website and which type fits its goal
- ☐ I understand domain, DNS, hosting, SSL and CMS, and who should own the accounts
- ☐ I can plan a sitemap, a content plan and a wireframe for a small business site
- ☐ I can judge a website on UX, speed, mobile and conversion in 5 minutes
- ☐ I can set up a GA4 property, install the tag and verify it in Realtime
- ☐ I know users, sessions, engagement rate and key events, and where to find the main reports
- ☐ I can create and test a key event (e.g. WhatsApp click) with GTM
- ☐ I can build a funnel exploration and find the bottleneck
- ☐ I can build and share a one-page Data Studio dashboard
- ☐ I run a monthly data hygiene check and turn insights into 1-3 actions